

Energy from food

Wave your hand – the energy you used to wave came from your food. Food contains stored chemical energy. Your body breaks your food down into simple chemicals that can be stored for later, or used to help you move and keep warm.

Calories

The energy inside food is measured in calories. We can use these measurements to compare the energy in different foods. However, food doesn't just provide us with energy. It also gives us important nutrients, so it is important to eat a balanced diet.

Carbohydrate

Bread, pasta, and potatoes contain carbohydrates. They contain lots of energy that is released slowly by our bodies. A slice of bread contains about 70 calories.

Protein

Meat, fish, eggs, and nuts contain protein. Protein is used to grow and repair parts of the body. A cooked chicken leg has around 150 calories.

Fibre

Fruit and vegetables are important because they contain fibre, vitamins, and minerals. Fibre helps our digestion, but it is low in energy. A serving of broccoli contains about 10 calories.

Sugar

Sugar quickly releases energy to our bodies. Too much sugar is bad for us because the body can't use it, so converts it to fat. A scoop of ice cream has about 130 calories.